

USER EXPERIENCE · 2026

The Journey Layout

A Markdown-native, list-and-inline-code driven user-journey diagram.
One layout, five variants — each answers a different question about
the experience you're documenting.

SECTION 01

Authoring · nested list + inline code.

How to write a journey

Sections are top-level list items **Tasks** are nested list items

Actors are inline-code `@name` tokens — appearance order drives the legend

Mood is `:1` (pain) → `:5` (delight); default `:3` if omitted

Volume is `+N` for the weighted variant — task width scales by this number

The same five lines of Markdown render in any of the five variants —
swap `journey` for `journey heatmap`, `journey curve`, etc.

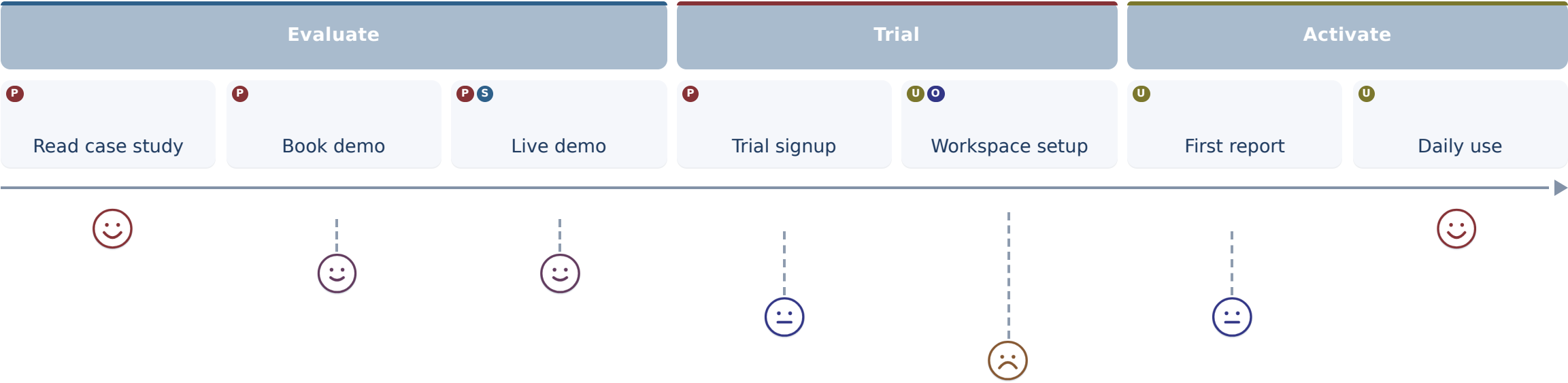
SECTION 02

Classic · the default Mermaid look.

Customer onboarding · trial → activation

P prospect S sales U user O onboarding

PAIN 1 2 3 4 5 **DELIGHT**



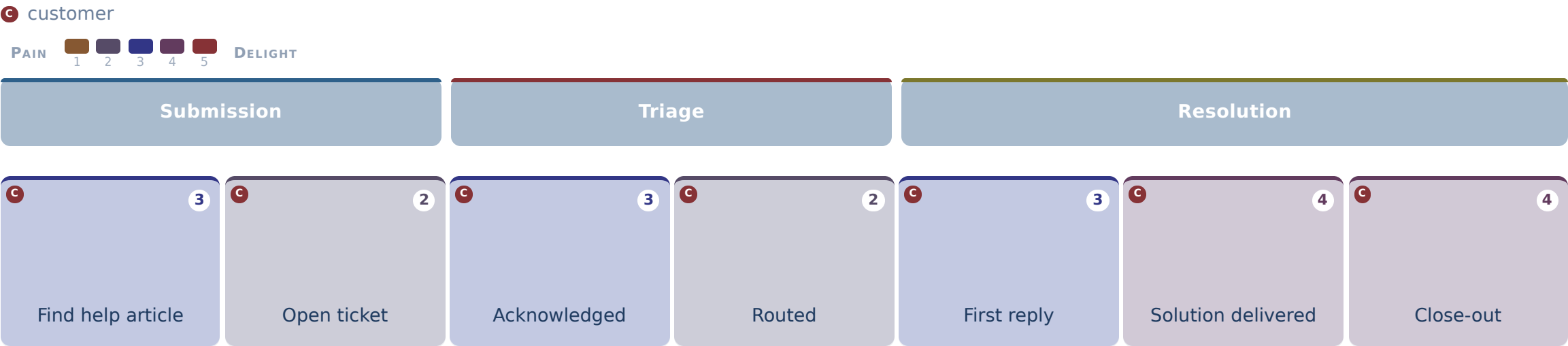
KEY INSIGHT

Setup is the chokepoint. Mood drops three points between trial signup and first report — the only stretch we own end-to-end and the only place we can move conversion this quarter.

SECTION 03

Heatmap · friction at a glance.

Support escalation · where customers cool off



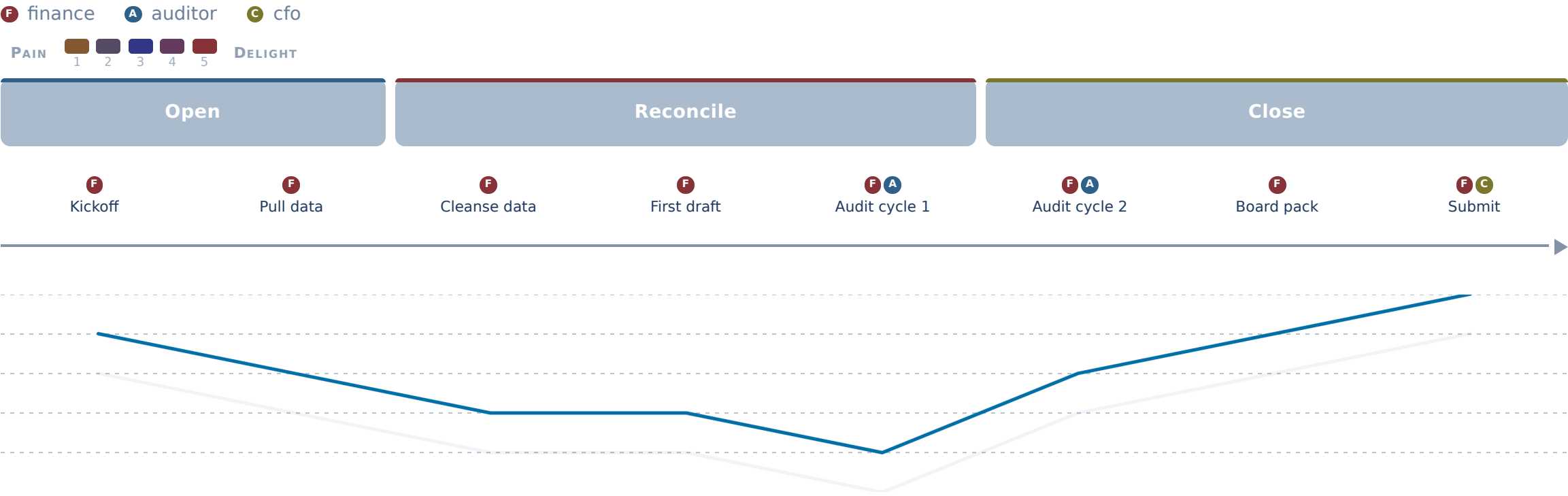
KEY INSIGHT

Routing latency, not solution quality, drives the orange band.
Customers rate the resolution itself a 4 (Solution, Close-out), but mood stalls between acknowledge and route. Cutting that gap below four hours reclaims the dip.

SECTION 04

Curve · the emotional arc.

Quarterly close · the J-curve of the cycle



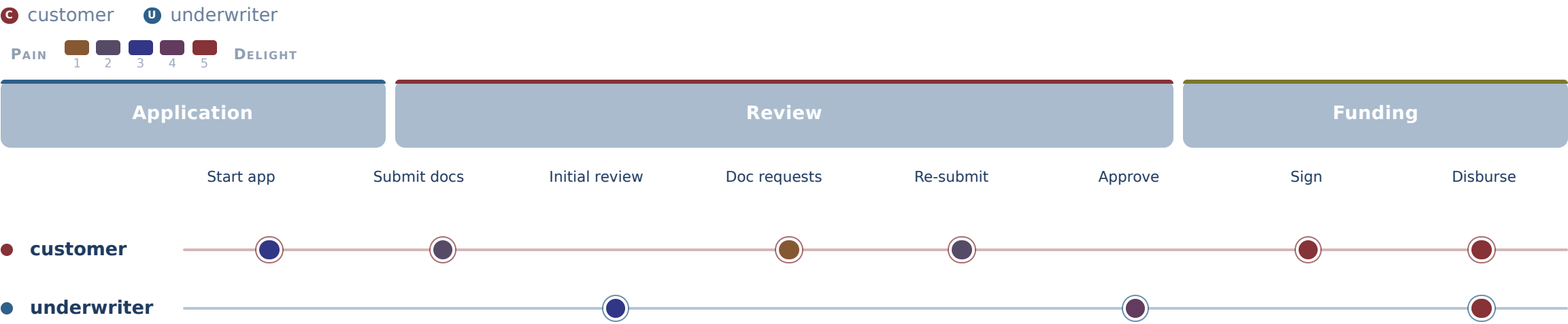
KEY INSIGHT

The trough is the audit, not the math. Close itself is technically straightforward; the dip is reconciliation rework and first-audit-pass surprises. Pre-audit prep is the cycle-time unlock.

SECTION 05

Swimlane · who feels what, where.

Loan application · two perspectives diverge



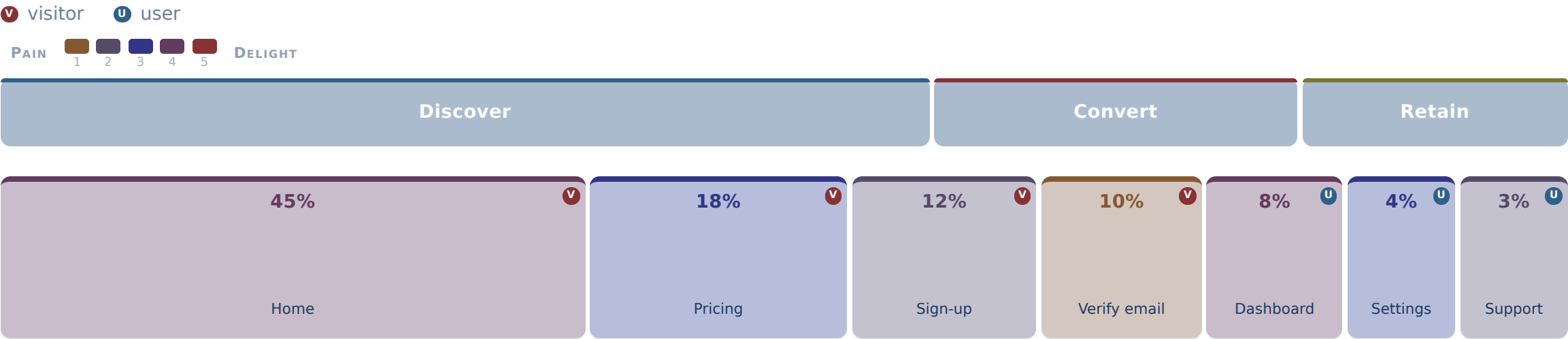
KEY INSIGHT

Customer pain peaks where underwriter mood holds. Their lowest point — doc requests at mood 1 — is our steady state. NPS will trail underwriting efficiency until doc-request UX is fixed.

SECTION 06

Weighted · volume × pain in one view.

Subscription funnel · prioritized by traffic × pain



KEY INSIGHT

Verify is the highest-leverage fix. 10% of traffic hits mood 1 at a single step we fully control. One week of work here outranks any home-page optimization on the roadmap.

SECTION 07

Picking a variant.

Which variant when?

journey — boardroom-familiar Mermaid look; lowest learning cost

journey heatmap — fastest exec scan; "where are the red spots?"

journey curve — narrative; "what's the shape of the experience?"

journey swimlane — cross-functional; "who feels what, where?"

journey weighted — decision-grade; "invest where pain × volume is highest"

Default is **journey** (classic). All five variants accept the same authored Markdown — only the class changes.

USER JOURNEYS, THEMED AND TOKENIZED

One layout · five views.

Same Markdown, same data, five distinct analytical reads. Picks up the active theme's palette through `--cat-*` tokens; mood ramp is `--journey-mood-1` ... `--journey-mood-5`.